

2026 CHAMBER OF MINES SAFETY CONFERENCE

THEME: SAFETY FOR A
RESILIENT TOMORROW

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MAKING SAFETY WORK WHERE THE WORK HAPPENS

The contribution of leadership
development to safety resilience

OUTLINE

PART 1: THE RELIABILITY GAP

Why safety system performance sometimes fail in real work

PART 2: THE HUMAN OPERATING SYSTEM

How mindset shapes interpretation and action, and performance

PART 3: THE LEADERSHIP RESPONSE

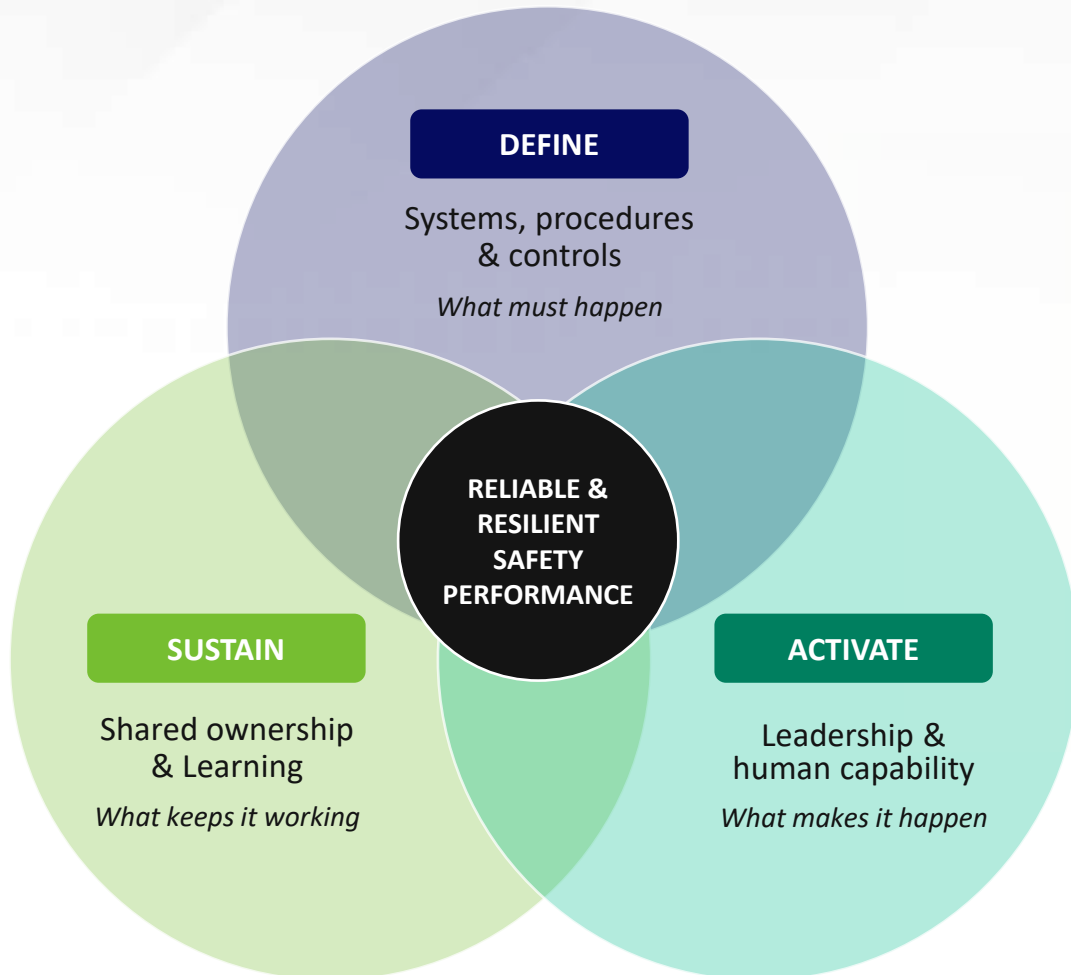
How leaders develop safety ownership, foundation for resilient performance

PART 1: RELIABILITY GAP

Making safety systems work
reliably in complex organisations

WHY IT MATTERS: ORGANISATIONS ARE COMPLEX

Systems, procedures and technology are essential; however, they do not make themselves work. People do.



- Safety systems define what must happen
- People makes it work
- Shared ownership and learning sustain it

The gap usually appears where work happens—when conditions become real.

REAL CONDITIONS DURING WORK EXECUTION

Which of these creates the greatest control vulnerability in your organisation?

				
Assumption	Pressure	Silence	Interface	Familiarity
<i>"Someone else checked."</i>	<i>"We need to get it done."</i>	<i>"I saw it, but did not speak."</i>	<i>"Their team knew; ours did not."</i>	<i>"I know this job."</i>

Safety system reliability is tested at a moment of work execution, when work happens

WHAT CAN A TECHNICAL SAFETY SYSTEM STILL FAIL TO SEE?

The technical system was present.
Monitoring, modelling, standards and
third-party certification existed on paper.

25 Jan 2019

12 million m³ tailings

270 lives lost

Technical operating system

- instrumentation • engineering standards
- audits • certification

Human operating system

- pressure • silence • weak challenge
- normalisation of deviance



Brumadinho tailings dam collapse — Vale, Brazil | 25 January 2019
A fully engineered mine system failed catastrophically in seconds

Sources: SEC complaint (2022); Vale Brumadinho update; ICMM Brumadinho anniversary note. Photo: Vinicius Mendonça / Ibama via Wikimedia Commons.

The control can exist on paper while its meaning is reshaped in practice.

THE LEADERSHIP CHALLENGE



Does your safety system show
up where and when it matters?

*Where work happens,
when it happens, **reliably***

THE CENTRAL QUESTION:



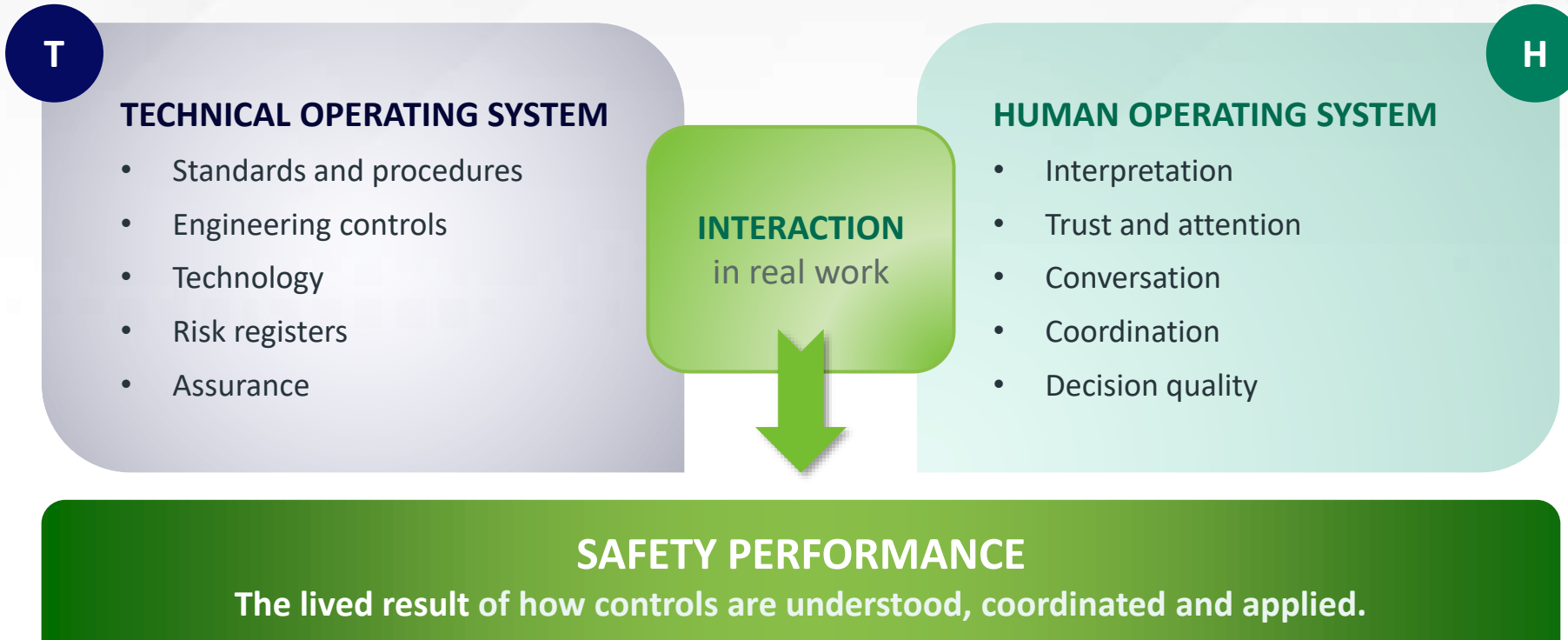
**WHAT MUST INDIVIDUALS DO
DIFFERENTLY FOR SAFETY CONTROLS TO
WORK RELIABLY IN REAL OPERATIONS?**

PART 2: HUMAN OPERATING SYSTEM

How mindset shapes interpretation
and action, and performance

RELIABLE SAFETY PERFORMANCE DEPENDS ON TWO OPERATING SYSTEMS

Safety Performance reality is experienced where technical controls meet human interpretation and action.



*The technical system defines the control.
The human system determines how it works in practice.*

SENSE MAKING AND MINDSET

Interpretation is shaped by prevailing mindset (Lens).

These mindsets shape how people understand the situation, relate to risk and respond in real work.

1 >

ANTICIPATION

Conditions can change;
weak signals matter.

2 >

INQUIRY

My first interpretation
may be incomplete.

3 >

SHARED OWNERSHIP

Safety belongs
to all of us.

4 >

COURAGEOUS ACCOUNTABILITY

I have a responsibility
to speak and act.

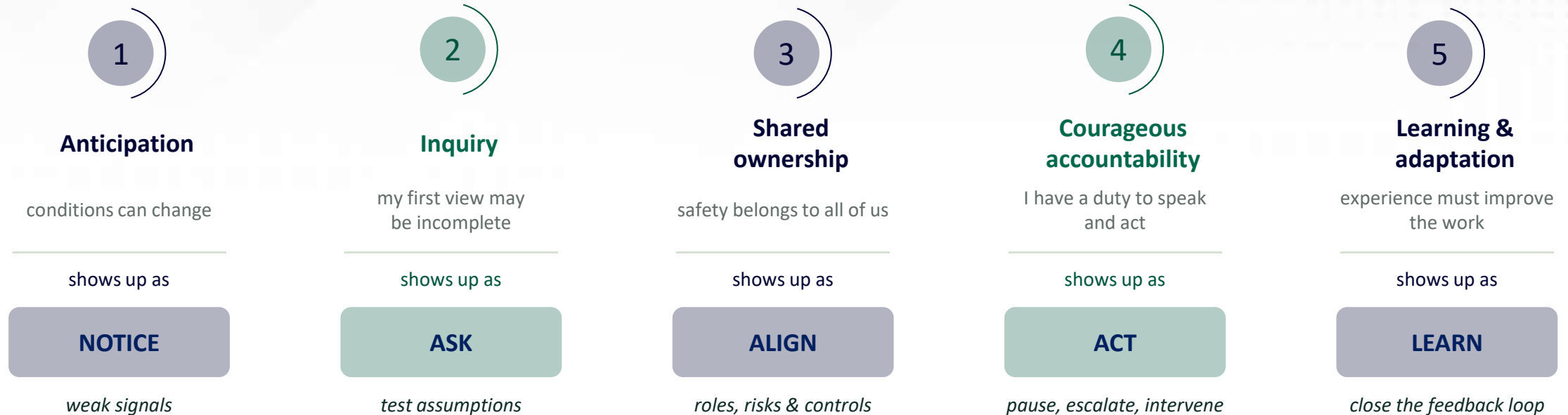
5 >

LEARNING AND ADAPTATION

Experience must improve
how work is performed.

SENSE-MAKING & MINDSET: MINDSETS DRIVE THE BEHAVIOURS THAT MAKE SAFETY SYSTEMS WORK

Central idea: people act on their interpretation of the situation — not only the written procedure.
What must individuals do differently for safety controls to work reliably in real operations?



Leadership responsibility: Shape the mindset and create conditions for people to notice, ask, align, act and learn when conditions change.

DEVELOPING THE HUMAN OPERATING SYSTEM



If mindset determines how people relate to the safety system,

how do leaders deliberately shape that mindset

so that the safety system shows up reliably in real work?

PART 3: THE LEADERSHIP RESPONSE

How leaders develop safety ownership,
foundation for resilient performance

LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT BUILDS SAFETY RESILIENCE

The sustained work of shaping the conditions and mindsets that make safety systems reliable.



WHAT IT IS NOT

- Generic leadership training
- A safety-awareness campaign
- More administration
- A once-off intervention



WHAT LEADERS SHAPE

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------------------------|
| • Understanding | <i>how people interpret risk</i> |
| • Voice | <i>whether people speak up</i> |
| • Coordination | <i>how teams align action</i> |
| • Accountability | <i>how standards are reinforced</i> |
| • Learning | <i>how experience improves work</i> |

Leadership development is not an event. It is part of how work is led every day.

Resource 1 of 4: LOGICAL LEADERSHIP METHOD

Clarifying the leadership work required for alignment, ownership and execution



WHAT IS IT?

A practical method that helps leaders clarify purpose, align people, establish ownership and enable execution.

CORE PRINCIPLE

The right leadership work, at the right level.

HOW DOES A LEADER APPLY IT?

Able to engage and lead teams for performance

Work planning

Team alignment

Execution reviews

HOW DOES ITD DEVELOP IT?

ITD develops the capability through facilitated role clarification, coaching and application to live operational challenges.

WHAT CHANGES WHEN IT WORKS?

- Clearer leadership contribution
- Stronger alignment and ownership
- More reliable coordination and execution

Resource 2 of 4: **PURPOSEFUL CONVERSATIONS**

Surfacing assumptions and building shared meaning before work continues



WHAT IS IT?

A structured way to help teams test assumptions, speak openly and make sense of risk together.

CORE PRINCIPLE

Conversation before assumption.

HOW DOES A LEADER APPLY IT?

Ask focused facilitation & questions during pre-task briefs, handovers, field interactions and learning reviews.

Pre-task briefs

Handovers

Field talks

Reviews

HOW DOES ITD DEVELOP IT?

ITD develops the capability through facilitated real-work conversations, scenario practice, coaching and repeated team application.

WHAT CHANGES WHEN IT WORKS?

- Assumptions are surfaced earlier
- People speak more openly
- Teams align before work continues

Resource 3 of 4: CONSTRUCTIVE ACCOUNTABILITY

Holding standards while enabling correction, ownership and learning



WHAT IS IT?

A leadership approach that reinforces clear standards without creating fear, blame or silence.

CORE PRINCIPLE

Hard on standards.
Constructive with people.

HOW DOES A LEADER APPLY IT?

Respond to deviations by clarifying the standard, understanding conditions, agreeing action and following through.

Deviations

Field coaching

Performance talks

Reviews

HOW DOES ITD DEVELOP IT?

ITD develops the capability through facilitated accountability cases, coaching, difficult-conversation practice and real incident learning.

WHAT CHANGES WHEN IT WORKS?

- Standards are applied consistently
- Corrective conversations become fairer
- Repeated deviations reduce

Resource 4 of 4: EMOTIONAL SAFETY

Creating the conditions for candour, challenge and early intervention



WHAT IS IT?

The condition where people can raise concerns, question assumptions and intervene without fear of unfair consequences.

CORE PRINCIPLE

People speak when leadership makes speaking safe.

HOW DOES A LEADER APPLY IT?

Invite challenge, listen without defensiveness and respond visibly when concerns are raised.

Deviations

Field coaching

Performance talks

Reviews

HOW DOES ITD DEVELOP IT?

ITD develops the capability through facilitated dialogue, leader coaching, speak-up simulations and reflection on trust and voice.

WHAT CHANGES WHEN IT WORKS?

- Concerns are raised earlier
- Weak signals become visible
- Respectful challenge increases

ABOUT ITD

Established 1995

We help organisations unlock people potential
for sustainable safety and operational excellence



ITD

Established 1995

TRANSFORMATION THROUGH PARTICIPATION

A thinking partner for
complex, high-stakes
organisational challenges.

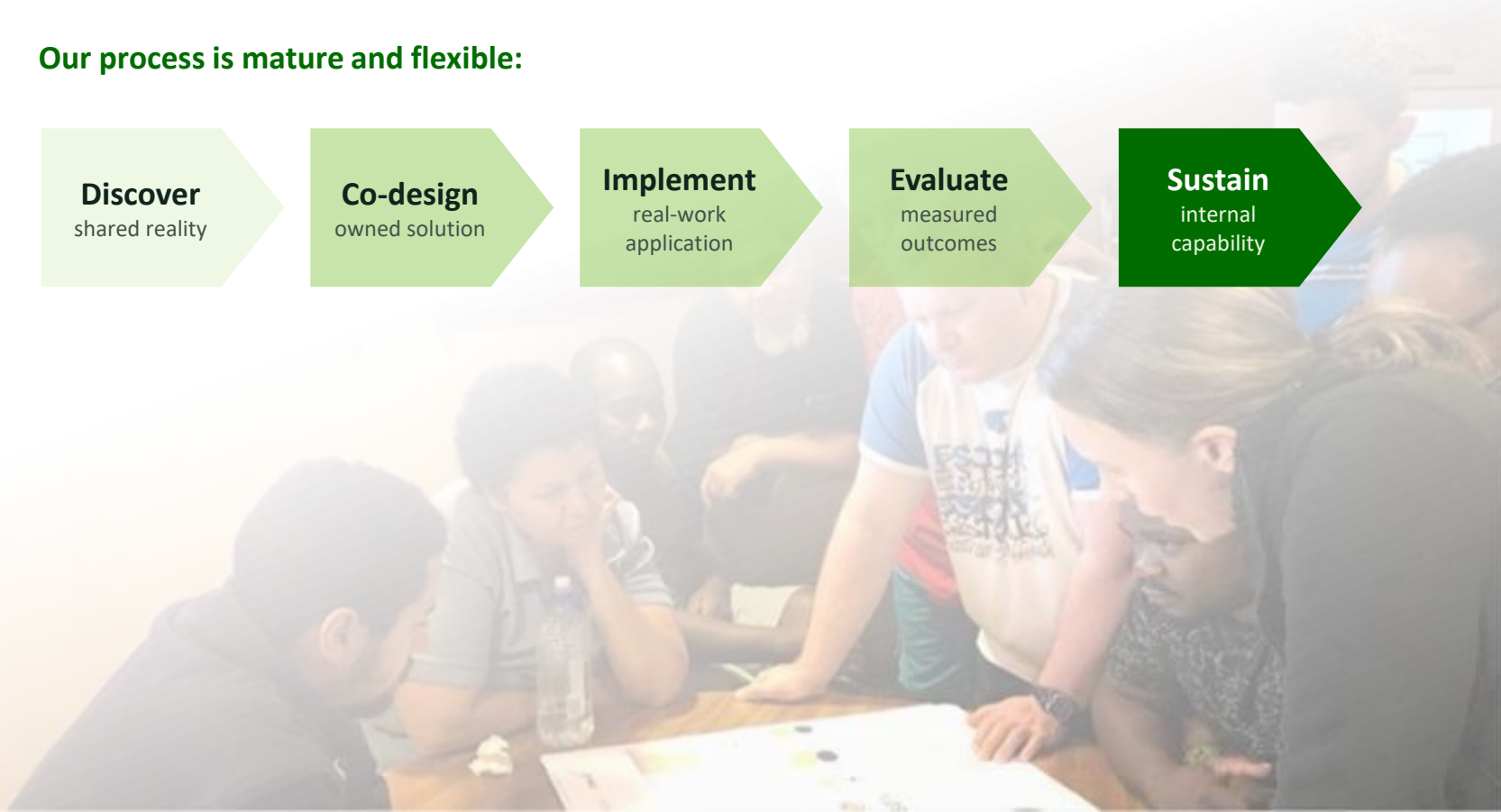


HOW ITD CAN HELP:

We help organisations **build** capable people, cohesive teams and ways of work that turn strategy into **sustainable results**.

ITD works inside the organisation, with you, building lasting ownership through structured conversation, co-design, and measurements.

Our process is mature and flexible:



OUR CLIENTS INCLUDE



AMALGAMATED STEEL



ASSA ABLOY



DE BEERS GROUP



DTC Botswana



ISCOR



PARAMOUNT



TFMC
ENGINEERING

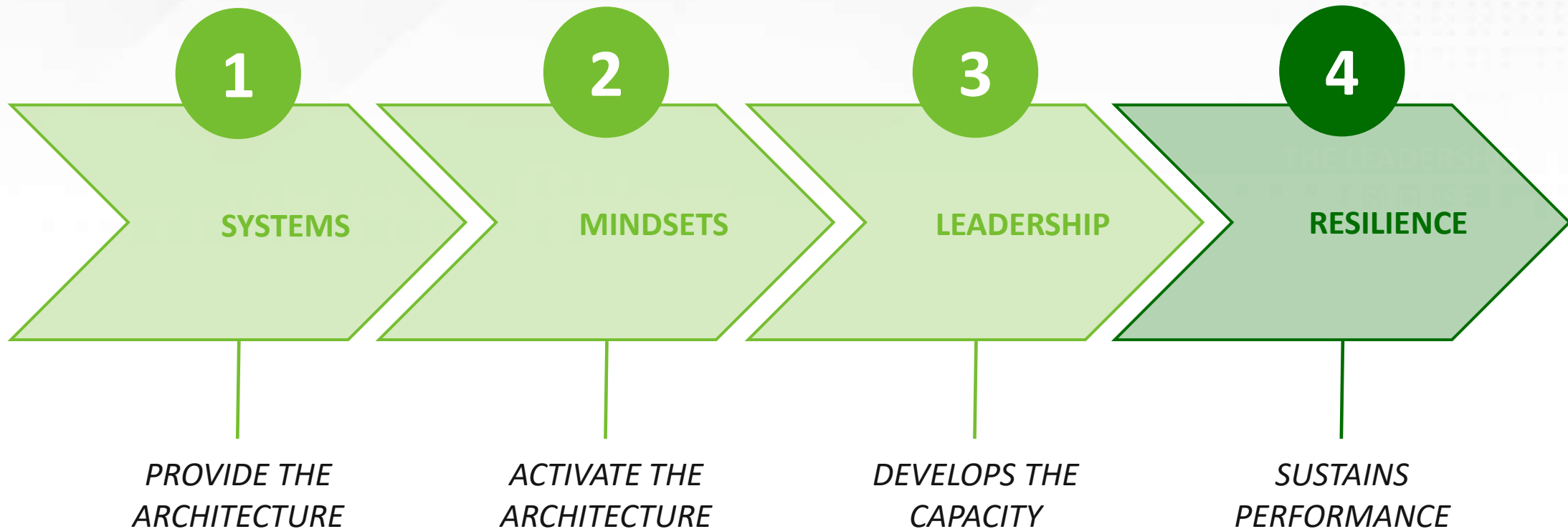


CONCLUSION

The Leadership Challenge

MAKING SAFETY WORK WHERE THE WORK HAPPENS

A simple recall of the argument



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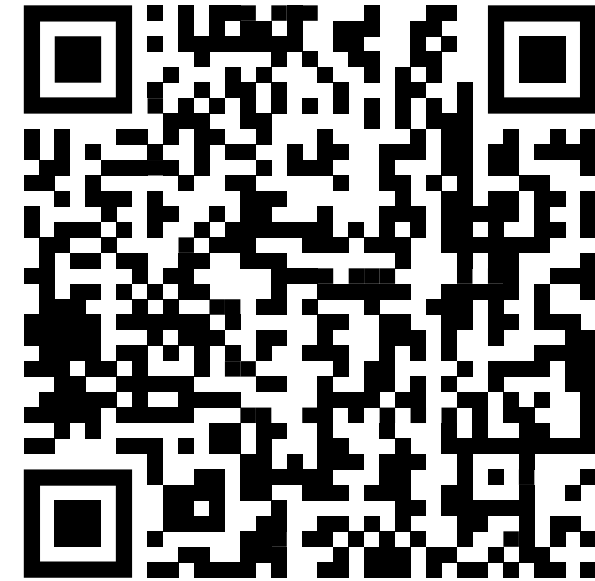
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